



AUSTRALIA IS AN ENORMOUS COUNTRY. It is the sixth largest country

AUSTRALIANS

A MIXED NATION OF PEOPLE

in the world, but very little of the land is inhabited. There is less than one person per square mile and, although Australia is

A way of life

Australians enjoy a hot climate all year round and spend a lot of time outdoors playing land and sea sports. Surfing and diving are two of the most popular pastimes. Team sports, such as rugby union and cricket, are also widely played. The country's teams are world famous—sport is almost a religion.



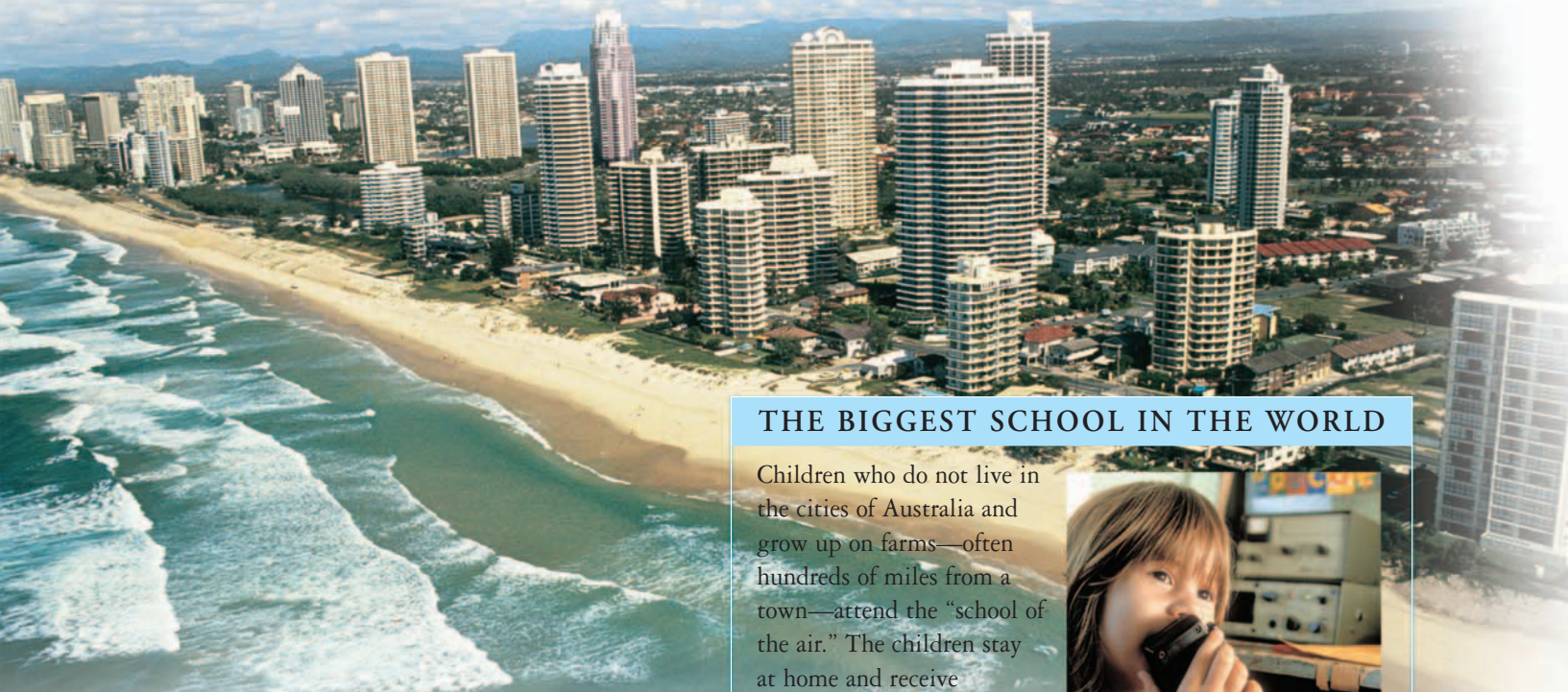
AUSTRALIAN RULES

Australian Rules is a game unique to the country and is a mixture of rugby and Gaelic football. It is played in every state and territory, and players are household names and treated as stars.



CULTURAL MIX

For thousands of years Aborigines and Torres Strait Islanders were the only inhabitants of Australia. In the 18th century British colonists arrived and the discovery of gold in the 1850s brought a rush of people from Europe, China, and the US. After World War II more people immigrated there, and today about a quarter of Australian residents were born in another country.



THE GOLD COAST

With about 300 days of sun a year, the Gold Coast that stretches down the eastern side of Australia is a true surfers' paradise. The sprawling region has grown up around an extensive stretch of beautiful beaches, which makes the area a very attractive tourist destination.

THE BIGGEST SCHOOL IN THE WORLD

Children who do not live in the cities of Australia and grow up on farms—often hundreds of miles from a town—attend the “school of the air.” The children stay at home and receive instruction over the air by radio and, more recently, over the internet. This “air school” covers thousands of square miles of Australia.

